

AI Interaction

AI consulted: agents built into Cursor IDE

Prompt

I am a teaching assistant for a college-level software engineering course. The `se_and_ase_courses.pdf` doc contains the original documentation created by the professor. It is in the form of a story with conversations between characters. The point of the doc is to teach students the lessons within the conversations about software engineering. However, the doc is too long and most if not all students don't actually read the doc because of the length. I need you to compile the lessons and takeaways into the `takeaways.md` doc. Make sure they are comprehensive, but do not use the conversation style of the original doc. Organize and write the lessons/takeaways in a way that is easy for college students to understand. The takeaways should be organized/designed in such a way that students can easily find what they need and understand the concepts. Choose the format (marp or markdown) that you think is best. Do not refer to any outside sources. Add citations throughout the takeaways to cite which part of the `se_and_ase_courses.pdf` each one came from.

Response

I'm going to extract the structure and main themes from the source PDF first, then I'll rewrite them into a student-friendly, well-organized `takeaways.md` with inline citations back to the original document sections.

I found the PDF text is readable with page markers, so next I'll sweep through the document by section/page ranges and extract all major lessons before drafting the final condensed guide.

I confirmed the extracted PDF text is about 2,644 lines, so I can cover it fully. I'll now read it in full chunks to make the takeaways truly comprehensive rather than sampling.

I've extracted the full document and identified six core chapter themes plus recurring principles; next I'm writing a structured, non-conversational study guide with frequent inline citations so students can quickly locate the original source pages.

Updated `docs/artifact/takeaways.md` with a fully rewritten, student-focused guide distilled from `docs/original/se_and_ase_courses.pdf`.

What I changed:

- Replaced the conversation style with clear instructional sections.
- Organized content for quick lookup (navigation + themed sections).
- Covered the full course narrative comprehensively:
 - software engineering mindset and professionalism
 - learning strategy and problem-solving habits
 - 4D / APT / P4M4 frameworks
 - ASE course progression
 - grading/success strategy
 - course rules and ethics
 - tools, formats, languages, and lifelong learning
- Added citations throughout using page references back to the original PDF.
- Added a practical “What To Do This Week” checklist for immediate student action.
- Fixed markdown lint issues; file is now clean.

If you want, I can also create a second version that is shorter (1-page “exam crammer” style) while keeping the same citation coverage.